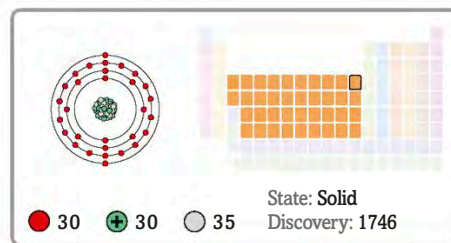


30
Zn

Zinc



Forms



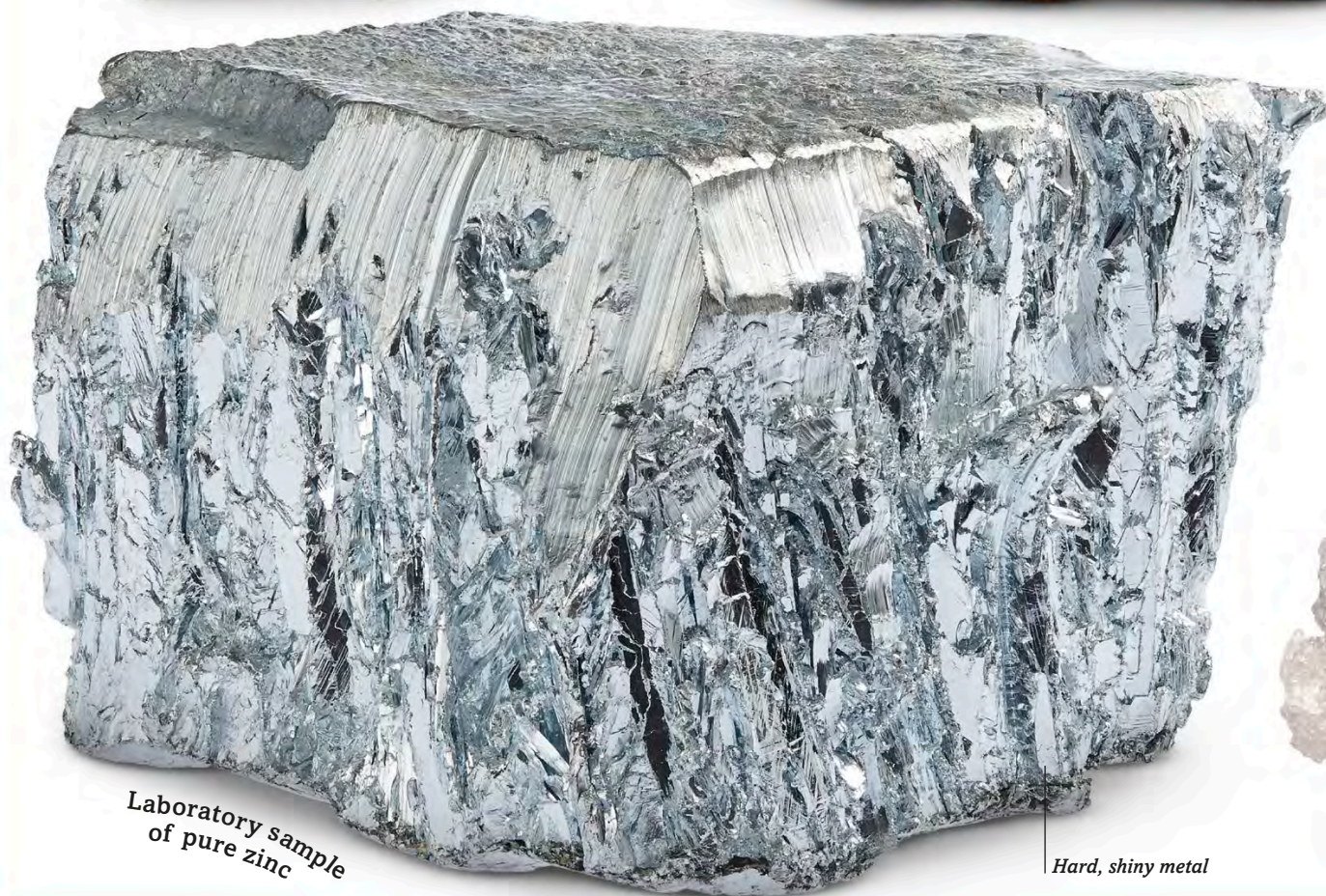
Sphalerite

This zinc mineral forms rough nodules inside cracks.

This ore is the main source of zinc.



Smithsonite



Laboratory sample of pure zinc

Hard, shiny metal

Zinc was used in India and China hundreds of years before the German chemist Andreas Marggraf identified it as a new element in the 18th century. This element is a rare transition metal that is never pure in nature, but is found in many minerals.

The mineral **sphalerite**, containing zinc sulfide, is the major source of **pure zinc**. Another principal mineral, **hemimorphite**, contains zinc and silicon. Zinc is essential in our diet. We consume it from food such as cheese and sunflower seeds. Zinc compounds have a wide